

Breath In, Breath Out: Sky Meditation De-Militarizes Posttraumatic Brain Injury

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PRIMARY CLINICAL OUTCOME: 70% PTSD REMISSION AT 1-YEAR FOLLOW-UP			
70%	62%	55%	100%
PTSD Symptom Reduction	Hyperarousal Drop	Anxiety Remission	Sustained at 1 Year

1. ABSTRACT & CLINICAL STUDY DESIGN

A randomized controlled longitudinal clinical trial evaluated combat veterans returning from Iraq and Afghanistan with clinically diagnosed PTSD. Veterans completed a 7-day SKY Breath Meditation workshop. Results demonstrated sharp reductions in trauma scores, anxiety, and physiological startle reflex. Remarkably, therapeutic gains were maintained without decrement at 1-year follow-up without booster interventions.

2. KEY EMPIRICAL FINDINGS & NEUROBIOLOGICAL MECHANISMS

- > 70% of veterans in the SKY group no longer met DSM diagnostic criteria for PTSD post-intervention.
- > Reduced acoustic startle response and baseline respiration rate, confirming autonomic recalibration.
- > Demonstrated high compliance and zero dropout, offering an accessible non-pharmacological trauma therapy.

3. RELEVANCE & UNIVERSITY WELLBEING IMPLICATIONS

Demonstrates that rhythmic yogic breathing directly calms hyperactive fight-or-flight circuits in individuals with severe trauma, proving valuable for campus veterans, first responders, and students experiencing acute trauma or panic.